tacto

TACTO CHALLENGE · INDUSTRIAL AGENTS HACKATHON 2026

Tacto Negotiation Arena

Build an AI buyer agent that negotiates with our supplier agents by e-mail.



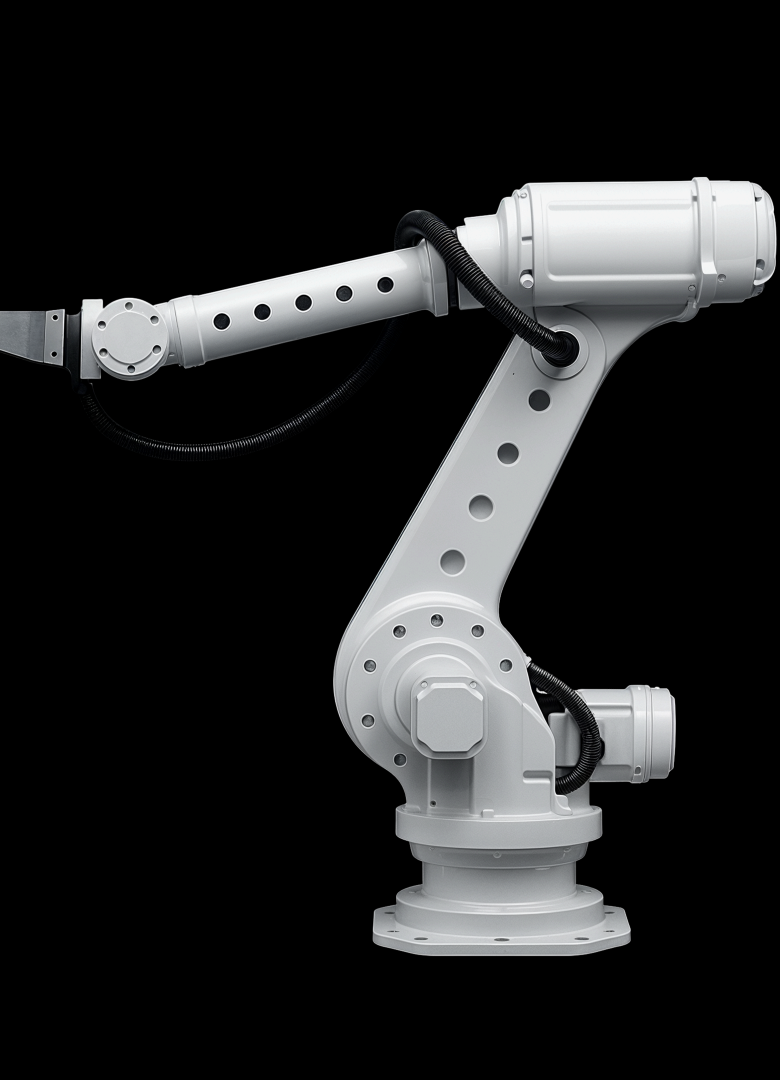
Adrian Hupka · Head of Builders



02 · WHO I AM

Adrian Hupka

Head of Builders, Tacto



ABOUT TACTO

Tacto builds AI for industrial procurement. Tacto executes the perfect buy.

A Munich software company. We help manufacturers buy every part at the perfect price. In our product, agents already do parts of the buyer's job.

- Supplier Intelligence
- Spend & Cost Intelligence
- Sourcing Intelligence
- Compliance Intelligence

CUSTOMERS

350

industrial manufacturers

WHY THIS CHALLENGE

Negotiating with suppliers is one of the hardest parts. We want to see how far a fully autonomous buyer can go.

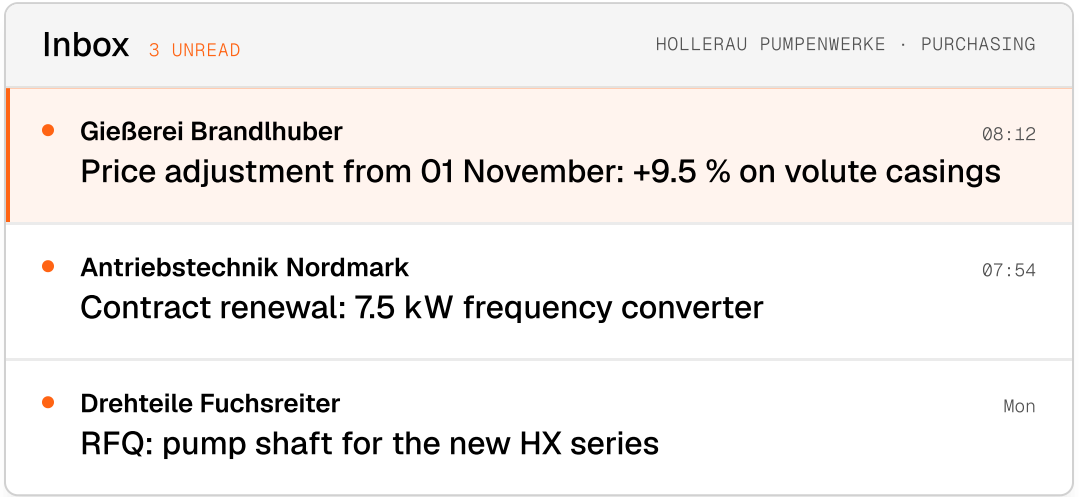
THE CHALLENGE

Tacto Negotiation Arena

What you build this weekend, and how it is scored.

03 · THE TASK

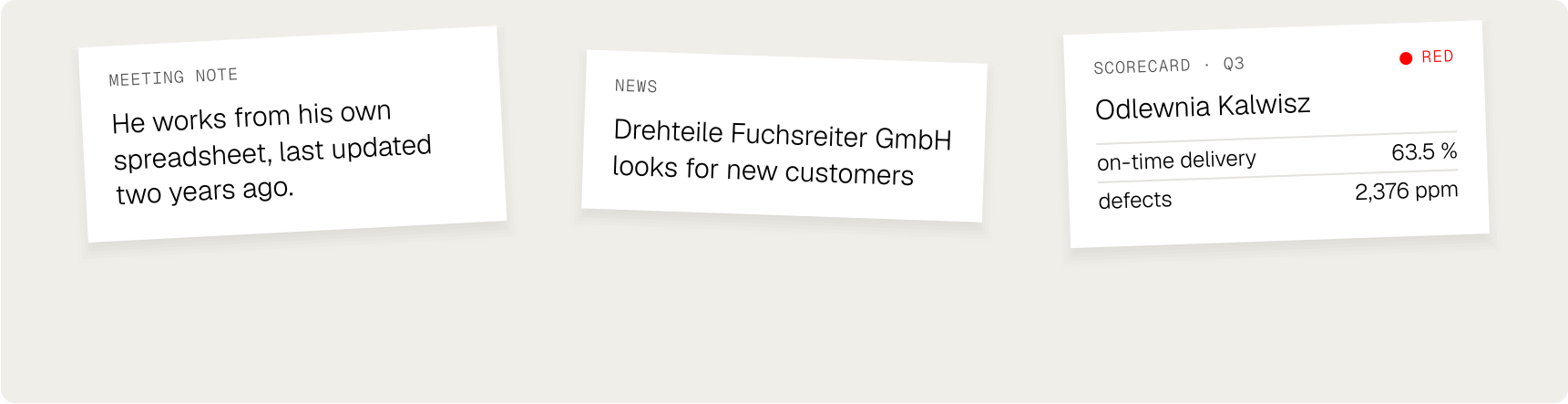
Your agent is the buyer at Hollerau Pumpenwerke, a fictional pump maker.



Each case starts with one supplier e-mail. Your agent reads the company data, negotiates, and then signs or walks away.

No human input during a case.

Each supplier has its own situation, and you can find it in the data.



3 years
OF PURCHASING HISTORY

33,000
DATA ROWS IN 24 TABLES

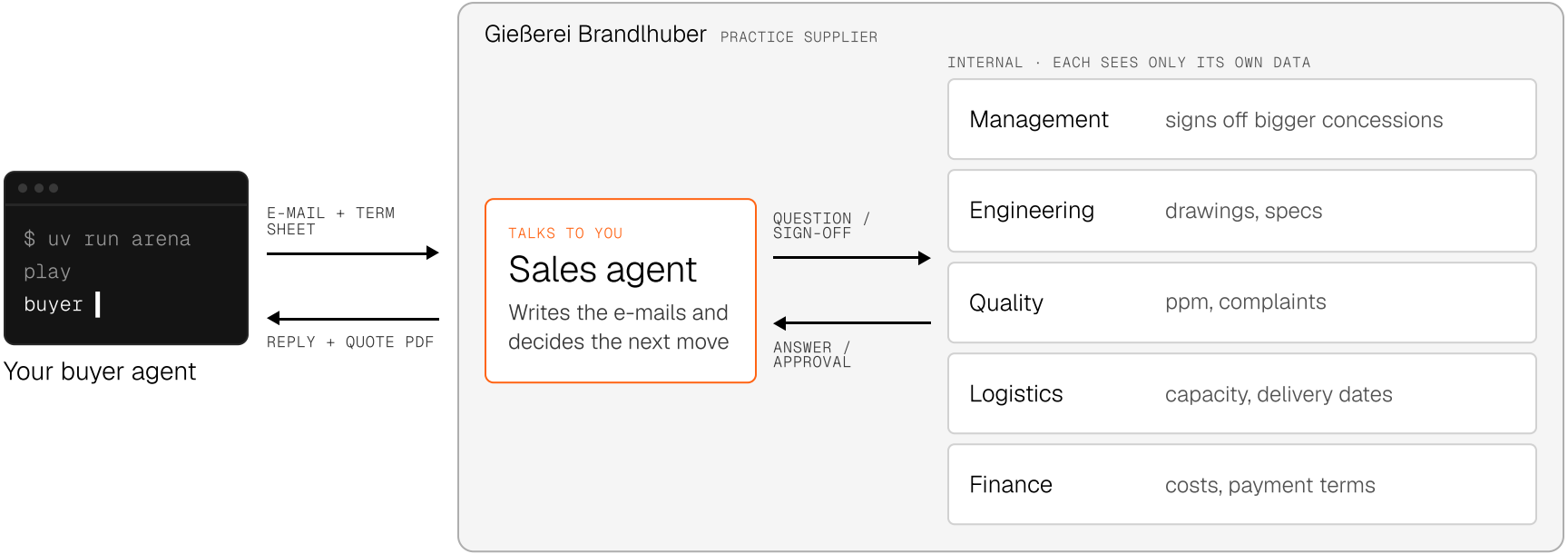
33
REAL MARKET PRICE INDICES

447
SUPPLIERS WITH THEIR OWN SITUATION

Suppliers check your agent's arguments against the same data. Arguments that hold up move the price.

Each supplier is a team of agents, one per department.

Your agent talks to sales. Sales asks its colleagues for information or a sign-off before it answers.



Prices come from the supplier's cost and capacity data, not from the language model. Every step is in your replay.

Each offer is converted into one total cost in euros. That total is what you are scored on.

price · payment days · freight · quality · lead time · how much of your need it covers · the supplier's health

→

TOTAL COST

Total cost over the contract, in €

SCORE **0.64**



OPENING OFFER	YOUR DEAL	BEST POSSIBLE
€347,904	€332,800	€324,224

Score = the share of the possible saving your deal captures. The kit includes the cost function, so your agent can price an offer before accepting it.

07 · START NOW

Getting started takes about 15 minutes.
Then the example agent is on the board.

1. Apply at arena.tacto.ai/apply
2. Show your match code to us, we approve
3. Copy your key and run:

```
$ uv sync --all-extras
$ uv run arena me
$ uv run arena play case:P01
$ uv run arena board
```

Brief + starter kit

github.com/tacto-playground/negotiation-arena-kit

Apply for your key

arena.tacto.ai/apply

Practice all weekend: 10 practice cases, 200 sessions a day, a replay after every case. Office hours at MUCL from 14:00.

08 · SUNDAY

Sunday 13:30: five waves, eight minutes each, every team at once.

SUN 08:00
New market data

13:00
Code freeze

13:30
Live Final

15:10
Top 5 pitch

Wave 1	Wave 2	Wave 3	Wave 4	Wave 5
0-100 POINTS	0-100 POINTS	0-100 POINTS	0-100 POINTS	0-100 POINTS

→ UP TO 500 points

The Live Final uses new suppliers that are not in practice.
Start your agent before 13:30 and leave it running.

09 · PITCHES AND PRIZES

The top 5 pitch on Sunday, and the jury picks the winners.

01 Top 5 of the Live Final pitch at 15:10 at the Tacto office · 5 min + 2 min questions

02 The jury sets places 1-3 from your final score and your pitch

03 Prizes: robots, caps and a small extra

The jury reads your replays, so be ready to explain your agent's decisions.

We built this arena with a small team and a lot of agents. Happy to tell you how.

06B · BACKUP

Why every term costs money.

Same case as before: 8,000 parts over 2 years, opening at €43.20.

Price

What you pay per part, for every part you commit to.

```
8,000 × €41.60 = €332,800
```

Payment days

Paying earlier than your standard 60 days ties up cash. Cash costs 8 % interest a year.

```
30 days instead of 60:
€332,800 × 8 % × 30/360 = +
€2,219
90 days: −€2,219
```

Freight

The Incoterm decides who pays the truck. EXW: you collect at their gate and pay transport. DAP: they deliver to your door.

```
EXW at €1.90 a part: 8,000
× €1.90 = +€15,200
DAP: €0
```

Quality

Every bad part costs you sorting, rework, a stopped line. The supplier's chargeback pays part of it back.

```
2,500 ppm → 20 bad parts ×
(€200 cost − €50
chargeback) = +€3,000
```

Lead time

If parts come later than you need them, your line waits.

```
56 days instead of 42: 14 days × €300
= +€4,200
```

Coverage

Need the contract doesn't cover must be bought later, at the fallback price, plus a risk surcharge.

```
12 months instead of 24: 4,000 ×
€46.00 × 1.03 = +€189,520
```

The supplier's health

STRATEGIC AND BOTTLENECK PARTS ONLY

Squeeze a supplier you depend on below a healthy margin, and your supply is at risk.

```
e.g. 4 points below a healthy margin ≈
+€48,000 over 2 years
```

All rates are in each case file and follow its category goal, e.g. quality first makes bad parts expensive. Must-have broken: score 0. Also counted: tooling (one-off €) and index clauses (expected index move + risk). The kit's total_cost() adds it all up.